



March 1, 2026

Parish Office: 585.248.5993
e-mail: fstjohnno@dor.org
stjohnfairport.org
8 Wickford Way
Fairport, New York 14450

St. John of Rochester + Fairport, New York

SOME THINGS CONSIDERED

THIS IS YOUR CHURCH, I AM GOING TO BED

It was said of Pope John XXIII that he struggled one night into the early hours, praying in the Chapel of his residence. He was wrestling with an issue of some import without a clear sense of the right way to go. It is reported that after a long time of prayer and no sense of direction he stood, looked at the Tabernacle where the Blessed Sacrament was present saying: "This is your church, I am going to bed." I have taken great comfort in that story since I first read it. Like John XXIII, we all struggle with issues that lack a clear and certain paths. Our scripture today mirrors that in the first reading. I said last week in the homily that the first eleven chapters of Genesis were not history, rather they reflect the deep faith of these ancient people who themselves looked on what they could not understand, seeing the work of God. At chapter twelve that changes. Chapter twelve begins recounting the history of the Jewish people. Our reading today is Genesis 12: 1-4, recalling God's call to Abraham with a simple instruction ... GO. No details north or south, east or west simply GO. God says to Abraham, GO FORTH. He is told to leave his home, his wider family, his livelihood, and 'go to a place I will show you.' We have begun this Lenten journey like Abraham and his immediate family, we begin in deep faith that God sends and does not send us alone. The same faith that fueled Pope John in saying, this is your church. In the gospel, Peter and the others get a momentary flash of insight into who it is they are following. It is only a moment, perhaps like

Abraham who knows something happened but cannot explain, much less repeat it. Most powerfully and important for us, Abraham does go, he goes in faith, Pope John does the same. Both go with firm faith that God goes with them. Despite mystery and unknowns, they believe, total trust is the foundation of faith. It is the faith we examine and through our Lenten works seek to deepen. In our gospel, the disciples and we are given a glimpse of both the object and the goal of our faith. It is as though the curtain is momentarily pulled back and we see where we are going. We see the purpose and result of our believing. The disciples get a glimpse of heaven, a momentary flash of insight.

We do, too, every time we come around the altar celebrating the Holy Eucharist. I said last week in the homily, there God transforms bread and wine into the Body and Blood of Jesus. Not a symbol, not a sign on our altar and soon enough within our very selves the full presence of God, the very Body and Blood of Jesus in Holy Eucharist.

The church through the centuries has proposed the work of prayer, fasting and alms giving as basic Lenten tools. Deepening our connection in prayer, letting the hunger or desire for what we give up remind us of a deeper greater hunger and desire for connection with God, and giving of our surplus filling the emptiness or need of a brother or sister near or far. Tools that build and strengthen what God has already given us: faith!

Have a good week. Love, *L. Peter*

All Masses are livestreamed on the Internet. Go to stjohnfairport.org and click on SJR Live Stream. Our Church is equipped with hearing-loop for hearing aid wearers. **Switching your hearing aid to the "T-Mode" position should allow you to hear the service.**

SJR PASTORAL STAFF / INFORMATION

PASTOR: Rev. Peter Clifford: 248-5993 x15;

fr.peter.clifford@dor.org

PAROCHIAL VICAR: Rev. Basant Nayak: 248-5993 x36;

fr.basant.nayak@dor.org

PARISH DEACON: Deacon Jim & Theresa Pegoni

(james.pegoni@dor.org)

PASTORAL ASSOCIATE: Rob Layer: 248-5993 x12;

robert.layer@dor.org

MUSIC: Valerie Gaudin, *Director of Worship and Music*,

248-5993 x13, valerie.gaudin@dor.org;

Jennifer Shin, *Assistant Music Director*,

jshin44@u.rochester.edu

FAITH FORMATION & YOUTH MINISTRY:

Anne Marie Egan, *Director of Faith Formation & Youth*

Ministry: 248-8850; anne.marie.egan@dor.org,

Rose Clark, *Administrative Assistant for Faith Formation*

and Parish Digital Communications Coordinator:

248-8850; rose.clark@dor.org,

Colleen Young, *YM Assistant*: colleen.young@dor.org

FINANCE DIRECTOR: Laurie Martin:

laurie.martin@dor.org

MULTI-PARISH FACILITIES DIRECTOR:

John Ciavarro: john.ciavarro@dor.org

PROPERTY MANAGER: Pat Bianchi: 248-5993 x19,

pat.bianchi@dor.org

OFFICE MANAGER: Shannon Wolf: 248-5993 x10;

Shannon.Wolf@dor.org ; (office) fstjohno@dor.org

MARRIAGE PLANNING: Contact Fr. Peter at

fr.peter.clifford@dor.org or 248-5993 x15. See parish

website for more information:

stjohnfairport.org/sacraments

FUNERAL PLANNING: Contact Robert Layer at

Robert.layer@dor.org or 248-5993 x12. See parish

website for more information: **stjohnfairport.org/funerals**

PARISH REGISTRATION: Contact Rob Layer at

248-5993 x12 or register online at: **stjohnfairport.org/**

registration-1

SAINT'S PLACE: Ministry that settles refugee families,

now completely located at St. John of Rochester. **DROP**

OFF donations Mon-Thu 8am to 2pm at SJR Parish

Center. Call Michele Quinn 585-385-6860 to volunteer.

HOME/HOSPITAL VISITS: Contact Rob Layer at

248-5993 x12 or robert.layer@dor.org

PASTORAL COUNCIL CHAIR: Mike Mason: 943-3423,

mikemason4752@gmail.com

FINANCE COUNCIL CHAIR: Mike Andrews: 474-6573,

mandrews555@frontier.com

PRAYER CHAIN: Contact Marie Kushner:

jmkushner8@gmail.com

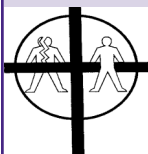
PARISH OFFICE HOURS: Monday through Friday:

9:00AM-5:00PM (lunch 12:30-1:30PM)

CONFESSIONS: Saturday 4:00-4:45 PM

SUNDAY MASSES: Saturday at 5:00 PM, Sunday at 7:30,

9:00, and 11:00 AM.



We Are A "Stephen Ministry" Parish!

Confidential support in difficult times provided by trained parishioners. Call 248-5993 x16.

PARISH NEWS

BELOVED DECEASED

Elmer Cogle—Father of Joshua (Marissa) of Callingham Road, Pittsford; Brother of Craig (Kerry) of Lost Feather Drive, Fairport

Thomas Penner—Husband of Anne, Father of Eileen & John of Hyacinth Lane, Fairport

PROJECT HUNGER

Want to make a difference for those in need this Lenten Season? Our parish is collecting food and/or other items each weekend during Lent for Project Hunger. During the weekend of **March 7/8**, all of the items collected will be donated to the **SISTER REGIS FOOD CUPBOARD**.

Please support those in need by donating any of the following items: **Instant mashed potatoes, cereal, oatmeal, canned mixed vegetables, canned corn, pork & beans, 2# bags white rice, crackers, pasta, spaghetti sauce, canned fruit, tuna fish, peanut butter, jelly, coffee, ketchup, cooking oil, sugar, canned soup, shampoo, toothpaste, bar soap and facial tissues.**

Please leave your donations in the Donation Room. Monetary donations can be placed in the Poor Boxes, which are in the foyer of the church and chapel. Thank you for your generosity!

Blessings from the Christian Service Committee



The Rev. Michael C. Hogan Knights of Columbus
world famous Friday fish fry is back during Lent

Location: St. John of Rochester Parish Center
8 Wickford Way, Fairport NY 14450

Dates/Times: Every Friday from February 20 – April 3
from 4:00-7:00 pm

Cost: \$21.00 includes baked or fried fish, French fries or baked potato, coleslaw, tartar sauce, roll and butter and lemon wedge. Free coffee. Cookies and brownies available for \$1.00

Dining-in or take-out available.

Please come and enjoy a delicious fish dinner while supporting the Knights and our charitable causes.

PARISH CLUBS / COMMITTEES / ACTIVITIES

**STEPHEN MINISTRY CORNER**

"Christ caring for people through people"

PULL YOURSELF TOGETHER

You've heard it a millions times. But things just aren't coming together. You're still hurting. You need someone to listen and to care, without judging or pushing you to get better. A Stephen Minister can be this person for you.

Call the St. John of Rochester Church Confidential Request # 585-248-5993 x16. Please leave a message and someone will get back to you soon.

VOLUNTEERS NEEDED

1-2 hours per month to bring Communion and a short prayer service to Crest Manor and/or Elderwood Village & Solstice Catholic residents; I am looking for 3 or 4 individuals willing to make a 1 - 2 year commitment (I said I was going to serve for a year and am now on year 20!) to bring the Holy Eucharist to the homes that we support after the 9 AM Mass. The commitment is approximately 1 hour per month (sometimes twice a month). I will work around your schedule; I ask for availability a month prior publishing a quarterly schedule and am able to accommodate snowbirds and/or summer absences!

A training will be scheduled when you volunteer!

Contact lauraziccarelli@yahoo.com

**Handbell Choir**

Handbells will play at the
March 14th, 5:00 Mass.

**St. Ignatius Spirit Group**

Have you *completed* the Spiritual Exercises of St. Ignatius of Loyola? Would you like to continue grow with St. Ignatius in a small faith sharing group?

Please join us at our **monthly** meeting for the **St. Ignatius Spirit Group** on **March 5, 2026 at 1-2:30 pm at Church of the Assumption, in the Living Room.** We are using the book: Seeing with the Heart: A Guide to Navigating Life's Adventures by Kevin O'Brien, SJ. **We will use chapter 7 as a conversation starter** for this meeting. If you need further information please contact Debby Orosz at debraorosz@gmail.com or call 451-2504. Hope to hear from you!



**We are looking for Adorers
on Wednesdays 5:00pm-7:00pm and
Thursdays & Fridays 6:00-7:00pm.**

If all these hours get covered, St. John of Rochester will have the Chapel open for Adoration from 6a-7p Monday - Friday; and 7a-5p on Saturday. This is a great blessing for our community. If you are able to commit to one of these open hours, please contact Judy Shanahan at (585) 880-3706 or Jeanie Sanders at (585) 615-5808.

FIRST FRIDAY BOOK CLUB

First Friday Book Club meets again on **Friday, March 6, 2026** in Room S7 of the Parish Center. Our book for this next meeting is: *Remarkably Bright Creatures* by Shelby Van Pelt.

SJR'S NEW WELCOME TEAM

In January, SJR started a Welcome Team to personally connect with new parishioners. When someone new registers – whether an individual, couple, or family – a team member ("host") reaches out to set up a casual, 30-45 minute visit at a convenient time, often after a weekend Mass. It's simply a chance to share helpful information, answer questions, and help them feel at home. It's not a recruiting meeting. We currently have 12 hosts, and each is typically assigned only once every 4-6 weeks. There are no meetings to attend – just about an hour of your time when you're scheduled. We'd especially love to have some of our younger parishioners join the team as "hosts", as many of our new members are young families. If you're interested in becoming a Welcome Host, please contact Mike Mason at 585-943-3423 or mikemason4752@gmail.com. It's a simple, meaningful way to serve and it's been very well received by those we've welcomed.



WHAT'S HAPPENING THIS WEEK

DAY	MASS INTENTIONS	PARISH ACTIVITIES
Sunday, March 1 Second Sunday of Lent	7:30 am—George Gradl—Linda Spencer & Linda & Zeva —Ralph Stover—Bob & Barbara DeClerck 9:00 am—Bob Raus—His Family 11:00 am—Beth Wroblewski—The Keneally Family —Caroline Roney—Diane Carlson —Healing and Comfort for Maddalena Marzocca —York Family	10:15 AM—Faith Formation—Parish Center 11:30 M—OCIA—LeVeque Room 3:00–4:00 PM—CYO Uniform Turn In—Gym & S8 6:00-7:15 PM—Women's Spirit—Gathering Room 6:30 PM—Youth Group—Gym 8:30-10:00 PM—Pittsford Senior BB—Gym
Monday, March 2	6:30 am—Peter Seidel—Jon & Mary Spacher 8:30 am—Joy Schenker—The McDonald Family	6:00–8:00 PM—Elevate Small Group—Gathering Room 6:30 PM—Faith Formation—Parish Center 8:00-10:00 PM—Pineapples BB—Gym
Tuesday, March 3	No 6:30 Mass 8:30 am—Gerry Caiazzo—John & Marie Collins	6:00 –6:45 PM—Handbells—Music Room 7:00 –8:15 PM—Joyful Noise—Church 9:00 –11:00 PM—Hickory Ridge BB—Gym
Wednesday, March 4	6:30 am—For Our Parishioners 8:30 am—Richard Burke—Chris & Dawn Pruszynski	9:00 –12:30—Perinton Artists 6:00—6:45 pm—Gracenotes—Church 7:00 –8:15 PM—11:00 Choir—Church 7:00 –8:30 PM—Scouts—Gym, Rooms S7, S8, S10, S11 7:00 –9:00 PM—Bible Study—Gathering Room 8:30 –10:30 PM—SJR Legends—Gym
Thursday, March 5	6:30 am—All Souls Intention 8:30 am—Katie Shepard—The Dispenza Family	9:00 AM–Noon—Fish Fry Prep—Room S8 12:30—3:00 PM—Women's Volleyball—Gym 1:15-3:00 PM—First Friday Book Club—Room S7 5:30 PM –Lenten Rosary—Adoration Chapel 6:30–8:00 PM—OCIA—LeVeque Room 6:30–8:30 PM– Spiritual Direction—Room S1 9:00 –11:00 PM—Men's BB—Gym
Friday, March 6	8:30 am—Lawrence DiRienzo Sr.—His Family	7:00 –8:30 AM—Men's Prayer Group—LeVeque Room 12:00 Noon– 8:00 PM—K of C Fish Fry - Room S8 & Gym 1:00 PM—Ignatian Exercises—Rm S1 1:15-3:00 PM—First Friday Book Club—Room S7 7:00 PM—Stations of the Cross—Church
Saturday, March 7	8:30 am—All Souls Intention 5:00 pm—James Kashouty—The Millers —Martha & Julio Chavez—The Chavez Family —Jackie Tiul—Steve & Carol	7:30-9:00 AM—Southern Hills BB—Gym 12:00 –3:00 PM—Gathering Room—Reserved—Egan 3:00 –4:00 PM—CYO Uniform Turn in—Gym & Room S8 4:00-5:00 PM—Praise & Worship—Music Room
Sunday, March 8 Third Sunday of Lent	7:30 am—Gary Sanuik—Tom & Ronnie Nescot —Julie Spinelli 9:00 am—Mary Jane Shannon—Her Family —Arthur Yockel—Bruce & Carola Hannat 11:00 am—Amy Bice—Diane Parker	Coffee Hours –All Masses 6:00-7:15 PM—Women's Spirit—Gathering Room 8:30-10:00 PM—Pittsford Senior BB—Gym

INTERCESSIONS / LITURGICAL MINISTRIES



PLEASE PRAY FOR THOSE IN SERVICE TO COUNTRY AND GOD

We Pray Especially For: Ens. Noelle DeMarco, Specialist Ryan Kelly, Captain Rob Prince USN, Lt. Col. Robert Kurpiel, Lt. Col. Christopher Kurpiel, Sgt. Travis Johnson, WO2 Jordan Torcello, Cpl. Ryan Palanzo, PVII Corey Pe-deville, Cpt. Jennifer Long, Sgt. Chad Griffio, Tech Sgt. Kevin Maeder, Sister Susan Marie Norton, PVMI, Sgt. Robert Chantra, Seaman David Barker, Col. Martin Schmidt, Staff Sgt. Alex Martens USMC, Pvt. Cyrus Goricca Marine, LCpl. John Hebert, Capt. Thomas Leone USAF, LCDR Alex Dudek, USN, Private Jackson Smith, Army, Captain Tristan Turkiewicz, USMC, Staff Sgt. Michael J. Coffey, USMC, 1st Lt. Clare Mulholland, USAF, Master Sgt. David Paddock, Pvt. Tristan Smith, US Army, Specialist Brendan Thoma, US Army

SJR EUCHARISTIC ADORATION

Don't forget that he is really there! "I am the living bread that came down from heaven." ~John 6:51

Open Monday through Friday 7AM to 5PM,
Saturday 9AM to 5PM, Sunday closed

COME LET US ADORE HIM...

Please CONSIDER taking a HOLY HOUR

NEW Open Hours—

Monday: 7:00am | **Tuesday:** 8:00am & 2:00pm

Wednesday: 8:00am | **Thursday:** 8:00am, 1:00,
2:00, 3:00 & 4:00pm | **Friday:** 10:00 & 11:00am,
1:00 & 4:00pm | **Saturday:** 8:00am, 4:00pm

Coming Soon: The Mary Adoration Chapel is going to be open until 7pm Monday – Friday. If you have questions or are interested in taking a holy hour, please contact either
Judy Shanahan at 585-880-3706
or Jeanie Sanders at 585-615-5808

PRAYER CORNER

Pray for our parishioners. Many names may no longer require this listing...please call 248-5993 to update.

Patricia Askloff	Jessop family	Katherine Sheehan
Lynn Barton	Baby Augustin	Bob & Jane
Dorothy Bell	Juarez	Shengulet
Allison Bianchi	Eileen Klem	Margaret Mary Shine
Jennifer Billone-Smith	Cynthia Klimack	Joann Simsic
Betsy Brown	Jane Konecny	Richard Smith
Louise Brown	Ken Kovach	Heather Smolowyk
Doug & Betty	Jamey Levy	Rosemary
Bufano	Amelia Rose LiButti	Stancampiano
Lucia Carr	Trent Lockard	John Stio
Sara Clark	Scott Macartney	Tim Story
Chris & Donna	John Maguire	Tara Vanderlei
Cleary	Gretchen Maloney	Connor Volino
John Cleary	Tony Marino	
Michelle Coleman	Jamie Mazza	Special Intentions:
Judy Collard	Simon McGarry	Noah, Kerry, Pat,
James Compitello	Kathy & Kevin	Lauren, Janis,
Dorrie Darcy	McKenna	Johnny, Tomasina,
Ann Delaney	Jeremy McMullen	Jeff, A Friend,
Faith Delehanty	Aurora Monge	Peggy, Alano, Lori,
Brian Dick	Olivia Morales	Ceara, Nicole,
Debbie Diez	Brenda Nawrocki	Christina, Cameron,
Mrs. Waltraud	Dan Nescot	Matthew, Bernie,
(Trudy) Doser	Ronnie Nescot	Baby Wyatt, Keith,
Charles (Chuck)	Phil Nothnagle	Shannon, Lindsay B.
Duncan, Jr.	John M. Palomaki	
Steve Elensky	Jeannine Pautler-	
Judy Erdesky	Jeanine Pickhardt	
Mary Ann Erickson	Susan Perlow	
Lisa Ferrari	Greg Poole	
Mary Kay Finnerty	Kenzie Poplaki	
Arnold Foster	Joan Pratt	
Bailey Frank	Michelle Puglia	
Rita-Marie Geary	Joe Reardon	
Eileen Gelke	Naomi Reichert	
Mike George	Norma Reilly	
Karen Grupinski	Marta Rodic &	
Bob & Peggy Hickey	family	
Patti Higgins	Robert Rodic	
Angela Hyman	Oscar Rodriguez	
Vivian Iaculli	Diane Roney	
Aaron Jackson	David Russell	
Michele Jackson	Kathleen Savage	
	Kathy Seifert	
	Olivia Shanks	

**PLEASE CALL
THE OFFICE
WITH ANY
UPDATES TO
THIS LIST
248-5993.**

LITURGICAL MINISTERS—March 7-8, 2026

Day	Greeters	Servers	Lectors	Children's Liturgy	Video Ministry
Saturday 5:00 PM	Ed & Fran Rosen	Ben Lickona Nate Lickona	I—Carol Smith II—Deb Buckley		Terry Egan
Sunday 7:30 AM	Linda Spencer & Linda	Annette Agness	I—Bob Slebodnik II—Tricia Kull		Gary Granath
Sunday 9:00 AM	Peter & Susan Hermann	Kate Duhamel Marcela Jaramillo Jerry Reyes	I—Michael Sullivan II—Deanna Wage	Children's Liturgy— Crisandra & Victoria Harrison	Hank
Sunday 11:00 AM	Rachel Connors	Patrick Bianchi	I—Elsa McMahon II—Debby Orosz		Hank

Solstice Senior Living—Christine Colao ♦ Elderwood Village—Bill Schlaerth
Crest Manor—Nancy Huff & Deanna Wage ♦ See www.stjohnfairport.org for the Daily Mass Readings.

SURVEYING THE SCRIPTURES



SCRIPTURE READINGS

Today, March 1—Second Sunday of Lent

Genesis 12:1-4a

"Go forth from the land of your kinsfolk...to a land that I will show you."

2 Timothy 1:8b-10

God saved us and called us to a holy life...according to his own design.

Matthew 17:1-9

Jesus came and touched hem, saying, "Rise, do not be afraid."

Questions for Reflection:

- What factors distinguish your origins from your present situation. What has been surrendered, and what gained?
- What aspects of your original plan never panned out? What did you receive that you would otherwise have missed?
- What passages in your life so far have brought transfigurations into view?

Readings for Next Week: Exodus 17:3-7; Romans 5:1-2, 5-8; John 4:5-15, 19b-26, 39a, 40-42



LENT 2026

WEEKLY BIBLE STUDY

Sunday Readings Father Peter Clifford
Wednesdays at 7:00 PM Gathering Room

KNIGHTS OF COLUMBUS FISH FRY

Every Friday of Lent - 4:00 – 7:00 PM –
Parish Center

LENTEN STATIONS OF THE CROSS

7:00 PM on 3/6, 3/13, 3/20, and 3/27

PENANCE SERVICE

March 21 10:00 AM – Church

INDIVIDUAL RECONCILIATION – CHAPEL

Diocesan Day of Penance, March 24
Sacrament available 10 AM – 8:00 PM
March 30@ 7:00 – 8:00 PM
March 31@ 12:00 – 1:00 PM
April 1@ 4:30 - 5:30 PM

TRIDUUM

Morning Prayer 9:00 AM
Holy Thursday, Good Friday & Holy Saturday
(Blessing of Easter Baskets and Easter Egg Hunt
after Morning Prayer on Holy Saturday)

MASS OF THE LORD'S SUPPER

Holy Thursday - April 2 - 7:30 PM
Adoration in the Chapel until 11:00 PM

CELEBRATION OF THE LORD'S PASSION & DEATH

Good Friday- April 3 – 1:00 PM

The Stations of the Cross/ Divine Revelation – 7:00 PM

EASTER VIGIL MASS

8:00 PM

EASTER MASSES

7:30, 9:00, 11:00 AM

LENTEN ROSARY

During Lent we have a special opportunity to pray the Sorrowful mysteries. It is a time for us to dwell on Jesus' suffering and His death. It is a time to look at our lives and examine our lives in relation to Jesus' cross. How are we like the Jews of His day who stood before the Truth and said Crucify Him?

Join others for a time of prayer and reflection.

We will be praying the Sorrowful Mysteries:

Thursdays during Lent

[3/5, 3/12, 3/19, 3/26]

5:30pm

Adoration Chapel

St. John of Rochester Church

livestreamed at:

https://c.streamhoster.com/embed/media/W9sdlg/G7S2WdvsmgR/QXBGvds2zAC_5?preview=1



STEWARDSHIP: OUR TIME, TALENT, TREASURE

STEWARDSHIP

Stewardship is also gifts of time and talent

Week of February 16, 2025

Envelopes	\$ 7,223.00
Loose Money	\$ 1,270.96
Electronic Giving	\$ 1,948.46
Annual	\$25,015.94
Direct Deposit	\$ 14,104.00
Total	\$ 49,562.36

Week of February 23, 2025

Envelopes	\$ 17,413.00
Loose Money	\$ 4,364.00
Electronic Giving	\$ 768.46
Annual	\$ 1,500.00
Direct Deposit	\$ 2,259.00
Total	\$ 26,304.46

The February 16th collection was incorrectly typed. These are the revised numbers.

Catholic Ministries

Appeal 2025-26

*"Together We Bring Hope...
and Hope does not disappoint"*

Goal—\$304,000

Total Donors = 629

Total \$ Pledged = \$350,026.90

% to Goal = 115.14%

Figures as of February 23, 2026.

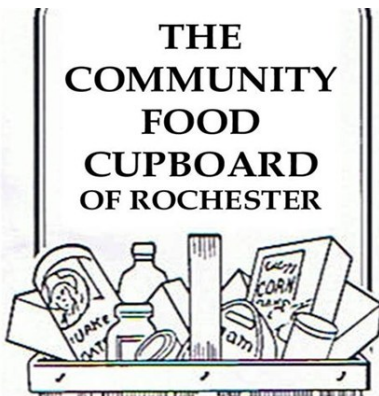


St. John of Rochester's March tithe will help feed the hungry at **The Community Food Cupboard of Rochester** on Nester Street in Rochester. They have been at it since 1979, when they were founded as a senior basket program that delivered food to the elderly population in the northeast section of Rochester. The program continues today and has grown to provide additional supplies such as clothing, diapers and personal hygiene.

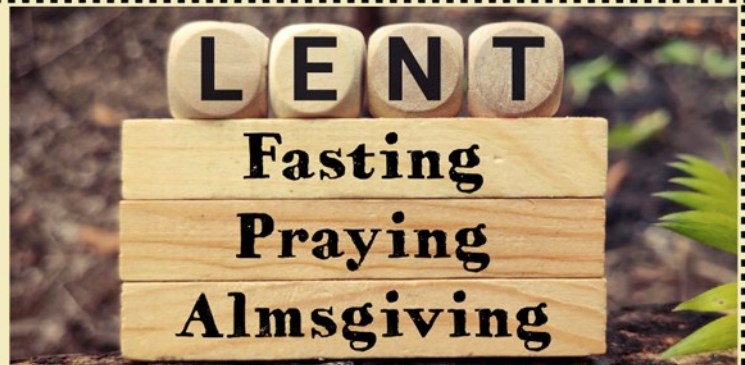
The purpose of The Community Food Cupboard is:

"To provide food to individuals and families when these people temporarily cannot provide an adequate diet by their own means or through public assistance. It also seeks to open avenues of self-support or public assistance to such people."

The Cupboard provides a food pantry for those in need in emergency situations. There is also a monthly, non-emergency delivery food program for older adults and individuals with disabilities. They provide information and referral for other services to assist low income individuals and families. If you'd like to learn more about this organization, or make a donation, you may do so by visiting rochesterfoodcupboard.org.



Faith Formation and Youth Ministry



Family Faith Formation Kindergarten-5th Grade

Sunday Classes- 10:15 am

- March 1- Children's Class
- March 8- No Class
- March 15- Children's Class
- March 22- Family Gathering

Monday Classes- 6:30 pm

- March 2- Children's Class
- March 9- No Class
- March 16- Children's Class
- March 23- Family Gathering

Middle School Faith Formation and Confirmation Preparation

Sunday at 10:15 am

or

Sunday at 6:30pm

- March 1- Class
- March 8- No Class
- March 15- Class
- March 22- Class

Vacation Bible School



July 6-11
9:00 am-Noon

Registration open on the Parish Website
for children who will be in pre-K -6th
grade in the fall.

High School Youth Group

Sunday at 6:30pm

- March 1- Meeting
- March 8- No Meeting
- March 15- No Meeting
- March 22- Meeting

Sacrament Prep

Children's Class

Held at the Parish Center

March 10 from 6:30-7:45pm or
March 11 from 4:30-5:45pm

The Family Fully Alive

Reflection for March- Family Difficulties



March's theme in The Family Fully Alive invites us to reflect on family difficulties. Suffering and struggles are an inevitable part of life. No family is exempt from trials, misunderstandings, illness, financial stress, or emotional burdens. Yet, as people of faith, we are called not simply to endure hardship alone, but to bring it to the Lord and offer it with Him.

When families learn to suffer together with Christ, difficulties can become opportunities for growth, deeper love, and stronger unity. God's strength is always far greater than any challenge we face. When we recognize our struggles honestly and place them before Him in prayer, He helps us carry our crosses.

Some family difficulties require reconciliation—with one another and with God. Through the Sacrament of Reconciliation, we receive not only God's forgiveness, but also His grace to heal wounds, overcome divisions, and restore peace within our homes.

During this Lenten season, we are especially called to deepen our relationship with God through prayer, fasting, and almsgiving. As a family, take time to reflect on your current challenges. Discuss them openly, entrust them to the Lord, and make them a daily prayer intention throughout Lent.

A Lenten Family Challenge

This Lent, choose one family difficulty- large or small- and place it intentionally before the Lord each day. Pray for wisdom, patience, healing, and trust. Invite Christ into your struggles, and allow His grace to transform them into sources of deeper faith and unity.

*May this season strengthen our families, deepen our trust in God, and remind us that with Christ,
no cross is carried alone.*

Thank you to the Knights of Columbus for the Family Fully Alive booklets and monthly reflections.

Converge Young Adult Ministry Upcoming Events

• **Women's Group! "Little by Little"**

- Tuesday, March 3rd from 6:30-8:00pm
- Christ the King Church, 445 Kings Hwy S, Rochester

• **Men's Small Group**

- Wednesday, March 4th from 6:00-8:00pm
- St James Church, Peace of Christ Parish, 130 Brett Rd, Irondequoit

• **Stations of the Cross**

- Friday, March 6th from 7:00-8:30pm
- Christ the King Church, 445 Kings Hwy S, Rochester

Find out more about Converge and their events at www.converge-roc.com or the parish website
Register for Converge events at: roc.converge@dor.org

Your Baby's Baptism

Ready to start the baptismal process? Follow these steps:

- Fill out our [Baptism Registration Form](#) on the Parish Website
 - Click on the Sacraments tab and then Baptism
- Once you have submitted your registration form, a member of our staff will contact you to discuss scheduling and answer any questions you may have.
- If this is your first child, please sign up for Baptism Preparation Class when you register for Baptism. The next classes will be held on March 15th at 10:15 am and May 15th at 7:00 pm in the Gathering Room at the Church.

Please contact Anne Marie Egan at anne.marie.egan@dor.org or (585) 248-8850 with any questions.

Baby Items Collection For Mothers In Need

Girl Scouts Tori and Hannah are holding a collection of baby items for the Women's Care Center to help support mothers who have said "yes" to new life.



We are working on this project as part of our Mary, First Disciple religious emblems program as Catholic Girl Scouts in our Diocese.



What the Women's Care Center collects:

- ♥ Sleepers (3-6month & 6-9month)
- ♥ Baby wipes
- ♥ Socks
- ♥ Baby clothes size 0-9 months
- ♥ Onesies
- ♥ Bottles (8oz & 4oz)
- ♥ Receiving blankets
- ♥ Crib blankets & sheets
- ♥ Enfamil
- ♥ Diapers (size 1,4,5)
- ♥ Hooded towels & wash cloth



Please drop off donations at

St. John of Rochester

March 7 to March 15

In the Narthex of the Church

Thank you for your support!



Holy Beginnings Outreach

Cordially invites you to join us in prayer and fellowship, for monthly gatherings of our LGBTQ+ community (family, friends and allies welcome as well).

First Thursdays Every Month

Thursday March 5th

**Mass at 6pm (adoration at 5:30pm)
Gathering 6:45-7:45 pm**

Join others from around the diocese!

**St. Rita Catholic Parish 1008 Maple
Drive, Webster 14580**

Holy Beginnings is a collaboration of Catholic faith communities fostering inclusion and dialogue to those on the margins of the church and society, allowing us, as children of God, to live our call authentically.

Learn more: holybeginnings.org

Contact: Deacon Jim Fien at James.Fien@dor.org

Deacon James Pegoni at james.pegoni@dor.org

PRAYER SHAWL MINISTRY

The next meeting of the Prayer Shawl Ministry will be held on Monday, March 9th from 1:30 to 3:00 p.m. in the Gathering Room. Let's anticipate Spring together with friendship, prayer and relaxation while knitting and crocheting for those in need of prayers. We would love to welcome new members. Come see what we are all about. Bring your yarn and needles or crochet hook.

Shawls can also be made privately without coming to a meeting. Before beginning at home, please call Judy Knab at 223-3434, Donna Stein at 698-5014 or Sandy Lund at 455-6401 for important information.

Prayer shawls will be blessed by the presider at the 7:30 am Mass on Sunday, March 15th. After this Mass only, shawls will be available if you would like to give one away. You may also call Judy, Donna or Sandy to obtain a shawl at any other time.

NEED A PLAN FOR LENT?

Looking to do something positive for Lent, instead of giving something up?

Become an Usher for Lent, and stay the rest of the year!!!

The Usher Ministry is a positive action, enhancing your faith and providing a great service to your parish. We are more than just collectors of money and finders of seats. We are the faces people see as they enter church and our welcoming helps set the Mass experience.

If you want to do something POSITIVE for Lent, call John Wessely at 585 737 5299, or email him at johnwsjr44@gmail.com.

To paraphrase Fr. Boyle, our previous pastor: "Make it a good Lent".

SECOND WEEK OF LENT